Prototype Interview Synthesis

1. Interview Overview

Seven prototype evaluation interviews were conducted across two team members. Five interviews (Aman) tested the original app-based prototype showing friend recommendations, group goals, and a shopping checklist. Two interviews (Kenan) tested the evolved NutriCart Hub physical prototype with Home Dock and Cart Unit.

	P1 (Aman)	**P2 (Aman)**	**P3 (Aman)**	**P4 (Aman)**	**P5 (Aman)**	**K-P1 (Kenan)**	**K-P2 (Kenan)**
Prototype	App v1	App v1	App v1	App v1	App v1	NutriCart Hub	NutriCart Hub
Shops at	Woolies, Fresh&Save	Online + in-store	Woolies, Asian grocery	Varies, has car	Closest store	Coles	Coles Milton
Shops with	Alone	Depends	Alone or partner	Alone or friends	Alone	Alone/ housemates	Alone/ roommate
Would use?	Yes, if friends use it	Some days, for ideas	Yes, would pay subscription	Some days	Yes	Yes	Yes

2. Key Findings - What Worked

2.1 Friend/Housemate Recommendations - Universally Valued

All seven participants responded positively to the social sharing feature. The ability to see trusted people's recipes and product suggestions was consistently identified as the most appealing feature.

> *"It's great to connect through friends to understand what they usually eat and what helps them get nutrition."* - P1
>
> *"I'd especially enjoy the friend system and the group goals."* - P3
>
> *"I can see myself going to the grocery store earlier while my housemate adds to the shopping list and suggestions."* - K-P1

2.2 Budget Tracking - High Demand

The running budget display on the Cart Unit was highlighted as solving a real, felt problem by multiple participants.

> *"Sometimes I forget my budget so seeing what's remaining will really help."* - K-P1
>
> *"Watching the running total update is satisfying, kind of like a mini dopamine hit, and it stops me from doing that thing where I get to the checkout and I'm $15 over."* - K-P2
>
> *"It completely depends on my month weekly pay as well, how much I'm being paid per hour. So I have to literally budget it according to my pay."* - P4

2.3 Shopping List Integration - Core Utility

The shared shopping list was identified as the most practically useful feature, especially for households.

> *"I don't have to remember what my roommate texted me a few days ago."* - K-P2
>
> *"I usually just get the same thing every time... I don't really think about it too much."* - P3

2.4 Group Goals - Motivating but Divisive

Group goals generated mixed responses. Most saw motivational potential, but concerns about pressure and unequal financial situations were raised.

> *"The group goals aspect introduces a shared objective and it will kind of pressure users like a peer pressure to actually be healthy."* - P3

> *"It's a pretty good thing if two people have the same goal, but sometimes it could be stressful for one person because if he's getting less pay."* - P4

3. Key Findings - What Needs Improvement

3.1 Physical Form Factor Concerns

Kenan's first participant liked the Cart Unit concept but raised practical issues about size and portability.

> *"It was a bit too big for them, if it was a bit smaller to carry it around easier."* - K-P1

The participant noted they sometimes use a basket rather than a trolley, making a clip-on device harder to use.

3.2 Product Comparison - Useful but Conditional

The comparison feature received mixed feedback depending on shopping style.

> *"I can see it being useful for bigger purchases, like when I'm actually unsure, but if it adds any real delay to a normal trip I'll skip it entirely."* - K-P1

> *"I grab whatever's familiar or cheapest and move on."* - K-P1

K-P2 liked that comparison didn't label products as 'healthier' or 'better', avoiding the preachy tone of other health apps.

3.3 Alert Frequency - Must Be Rare

Context alerts were valued in principle but participants warned about notification overload.

> *"If every second aisle my cart is buzzing with a housemate's opinion, that's going to feel like noise, not help, and I'll start ignoring it entirely."* - K-P2

K-P2 said deals and already-at-home alerts are the most valuable because they are 'money saving', but housemate suggestions should be infrequent.

3.4 Home Dock Data Entry Barrier

A practical concern about the Home Dock was the effort required to input data.

> *"Adding the ingredients and suggestions to the home unit will be a pain to do for me and my housemates."* - K-P1

3.5 Handling Off-List Items

K-P2 raised an important edge case about spontaneous purchases.

> *"If there was a sale on avocados will it let me add them or have to add to home dock to work?"* - K-P2

4. Design Implications

- Keep the Cart Unit as simple as possible - shopping list, budget, and alerts only. Comparison should be opt-in, not a default flow.
- Reduce Home Dock data entry friction - allow voice input, barcode scanning, or auto-suggestions based on purchase history.
- Make alert frequency configurable - default to low, let users increase if desired. Deals and already-at-home alerts are highest priority.
- Allow adding off-list items directly on the Cart Unit - don't force return to Home Dock for spontaneous purchases.

- Consider a smaller Cart Unit form factor - clip-on for trolley AND a wrist/pocket version for basket shoppers.
- Don't label anything as 'healthy' or 'unhealthy' - the system provides information, users decide. This was validated by K-P2's feedback about preachy apps.
- Budget display is essential - make it the most prominent element on the Cart Unit screen.
- Group goals should be optional, not default - some users feel pressured by financial inequality.
- The 'who added what' feature has limited appeal unless tied to cost-splitting or allergy management.
- Brand-specific recommendations and unit pricing were requested - add these to comparison and list views.

5. Feature Suggestions from Participants

- Map showing different grocery stores + friends' shopping history at unique/cultural groceries (P3)
- Partnership with local groceries for group-goal-completion coupons/discounts (P3)
- Specific brand names in shopping list, not just generic ingredient names (K-P1)
- Unit price display option (K-P1)
- Ability to add items on the Cart Unit without returning to Home Dock (K-P2)
- Due dates on group goals for accountability (P1)

6. Overall Sentiment

All seven participants said they would use the system. Three gave unconditional yes responses, two said they would use it on specific occasions (for meal ideas or when budget-conscious), and two from the NutriCart Hub testing responded positively to the evolved physical concept. One participant (P3) said they would pay a subscription fee, indicating strong perceived value.

The strongest signal across all interviews: students want practical help with budget and meal variety, delivered through trusted social connections, without being judged on their food choices. The NutriCart Hub's non-judgmental, information-first approach directly addresses this.